

When Salary Cannot Move

A respectful negotiation recognises constraints while still clarifying what matters most.

THE DECISION

Some employers, sectors and salary structures have limited flexibility. That does not prevent a candidate from understanding the overall package, asking informed questions or considering other terms that may matter to the decision.

THREE MOVES

→ Ask which parts of the package are governed by policy and which, if any, are open to discussion.

→ Prioritise one or two requests tied to your decision instead of producing an unfocused list.

→ If the offer is fair for your priorities, acceptance without negotiation can still be a deliberate choice.

TRY THIS BEFORE YOUR NEXT STEP

Complete this sentence: “If base salary is fixed, the information or term that would most affect my decision is...” Use the answer to guide one focused conversation.

Reading note: This is a sample briefing for educational reading. It is not a historic newsletter send and does not guarantee an interview, offer or outcome. Framework reference: [DePaul Career Center — Job Offers & Salary Negotiation](#).